

LaunchPad

Build brief and design guidelines for Claude Code

A free, international website that teaches business and money to 15-21 year-olds, with articles, interactive tools, and quizzes. Built for phones and slow connections.

Prepared for: Rajvir Dixit, founder of Business Lab

Version: 1.1 · September 17, 2026

Project folder: Desktop / passion project (GitHub: passion-project)

How to use this document

This PDF is for you to read. The same plan is saved as **Markdown files** inside your passion project folder, which is what Claude Code actually reads:

```
passion project/
  CLAUDE.md          short rules Claude Code loads every session
  docs/PROJECT_BRIEF.md the full plan (sections 1-15 of this PDF)
  docs/DESIGN.md      the look and "don't look AI-made" rules
  docs/CONTENT_GUIDE.md article format, voice, finance limits
  docs/KICKOFF_PROMPTS.md the exact prompts to start with
  docs/LaunchPad_Build_Brief.pdf this PDF
  index.html, about.html, articles/, css/, js/ your existing site
```

Then follow KICKOFF_PROMPTS.md: start Claude Code in **plan mode**, let it interview you, build one phase at a time, and **always ask for proof** (test results + screenshots). Anthropic's own Claude Code guidance says the biggest wins come from giving Claude a way to check its work, planning before coding, keeping CLAUDE.md short, and clearing context between unrelated tasks.

What the research says (and how it shaped this plan)

Finding	Design decision
~18% of 15-year-olds in OECD countries lack basic financial literacy (PISA 2022)	Beginner-first lessons, define every term, quizzes
India: ~958M active internet users, 57% rural, ~18% on shared devices (IAMAI 2025)	Phone-first, slow-network budget, no sign-up, INR/lakh formatting, Hindi in v2
Teens read less and less patiently than adults, reject "kiddie" design, abandon slow sites, and like interactivity that does something (Nielsen Norman Group)	Short chunks, fast pages, useful tools instead of decoration, no "kids" branding
Young adults (18-25) are confident but error-prone and dislike being talked down to (Nielsen Norman Group)	Clear labels, forgiving inputs, peer voice
Quizzing (retrieval practice) improves long-term learning (retrieval practice research)	A short quiz on every lesson
AI-generated sites share tells: Inter everywhere, purple gradients, centered hero + badge, identical icon cards, glows (Anthropic frontend guidance; design critiques)	DESIGN.md bans them and gives a checklist
WCAG 2.2 added target size (24px min), focus-not-obscured, no drag-only, consistent help	Built into the accessibility section
India's DPDP Rules: under-18 data needs verifiable parental consent; main duties from May 13, 2027. GDPR sets 13-16 by country.	Collect no personal data in v1
SEBI (Jan 2025): no advice under the name of education; Indian market prices in education must be ≥ 3 months old	Education-only content rules
Astro ships zero JS by default and hydrates only "islands"; Pagefind gives static low-bandwidth search	Tech stack choice

Project Brief: LaunchPad

Version 1.1, Sept 17, 2026. Author: Rajvir Dixit (with research help from Claude).

1. Vision

LaunchPad is a free, clean, fast website where anyone aged 15-21, anywhere in the world, can learn how money and business work, then practice with interactive tools. It's a hub: short articles on ideas that affect this age group, plus calculators, quizzes, and builders you can use on a phone.

Why it matters

- Across OECD countries, about 18% of 15-year-olds lack basic financial literacy (PISA 2022, 20 countries and economies). Access to financial education in school explains about 20% of the variation in scores.
- India has about 958 million active internet users (IAMAI, 2025). 57% are rural, and rural growth runs about 4x faster than urban. About 18% access the internet through shared devices. Many young people there have internet but no advisor and no business tools. That's who this is for.
- It extends Business Lab's mission ("business is a life skill") from one school to the world.

2. Audience and personas (fictional)

Persona	Context	Needs
Priya, 16, Nagpur (India)	Budget Android phone, sometimes shared with family, patchy 4G, reads English but prefers Hindi for hard ideas	Short lessons, works on slow data, Hindi later, INR and lakh formatting, no sign-up
Marcus, 17, Rochester (USA)	Business Lab member, school Chromebook plus iPhone	Quick explainers before club events, tools to use in club challenges
Ana, 19, São Paulo (Brazil)	First-year university student selling crochet on Instagram	Pricing and profit tools, how to register a small business (general, points to official sources)
Rahul, 21, Indore (India)	Wants to open a small tea and snacks stall	Break-even and loan/EMI tools, one-page business plan, scam awareness

3. Product principles

1. **Useful in 5 minutes.** Every page teaches one idea or helps finish one task.
2. **Phone first, slow network first.** Test on a mid-range Android over throttled 4G.
3. **No sign-up, no tracking.** Nothing personal is collected in v1.
4. **Peer voice, not "kiddie," not corporate.** Talk like a smart older student.
5. **Global by default.** Examples from India, the US, Brazil, Nigeria, and Europe. Currency and number formats adapt.
6. **Do, don't just read.** Every article ends with a tool, a quiz, or a small challenge.
7. **Honest.** Sources on every article, clear "education, not advice" limits.
8. **Accessible to everyone.** WCAG 2.2 AA minimum.
9. **Human-designed look.** See DESIGN.md.
10. **Built to last cheaply.** Static site, free hosting tier, no servers to maintain in v1.

4. Scope

v1 (MVP), target 6 weeks

- 3 learning tracks, 12 articles (4 per track), English only
- 5 tools: Budget Planner, Savings & Compound Growth, Pricing & Break-even, Side-Hustle Profit, Loan/EMI
- Quiz component (3-5 questions per article, with instant feedback)

- Glossary (40+ terms) with tap-to-define inside articles
- Site search (Pagefind)
- Currency/locale picker (INR, USD, EUR, BRL, NGN, GBP) saved in localStorage
- Local progress: "read" and "quiz passed" checkmarks (localStorage)
- Pages: Home, Learn, Track, Article, Tools, Tool, Glossary, Search, About, Write for Us, Privacy, Disclaimer, 404
- Cookieless analytics with events: article_read, quiz_completed, tool_used (no personal data)

v2, months 2-4

- Hindi (hi) translation of all v1 content and UI (human-reviewed)
- 24+ articles; contributor program (student writers)
- One-Page Business Plan Builder (local only, print or save as PDF)
- "Run a Chai Stall" scenario simulator
- Offline reading (PWA: cache read articles)
- Teacher/club kit pages (printable lesson plans for Business Lab-style clubs)

Later (only after legal review)

- More languages (Spanish, Portuguese, Swahili, Arabic with RTL)
- Moderated community Q&A
- Optional accounts (requires parental-consent handling for under-18 users in India, and in EU countries below their age of digital consent)

Non-goals

- Stock tips or personalized financial advice
- Paid courses, ads, affiliate links, or selling user data
- AI chatbot "advisor" in v1 (risk of wrong or personalized advice)
- Comments or user uploads in v1

5. Information architecture

/	Home
/learn	All tracks
/learn/[track]	Track overview (ordered lessons)
/learn/[track]/[slug]	Article (lesson)
/tools	Tools index
/tools/[tool]	Tool page
/glossary	Glossary (A-Z, searchable)
/search	Search results (Pagefind)
/about	Mission, team, impact numbers
/write	Write for us (student contributors)
/privacy	Privacy notice (plain language)
/disclaimer	Education-not-advice + limitations
/hi/...	Hindi mirror (v2)

Main nav (max 5): Learn · Tools · Glossary · About · Search. Language and currency picker lives in the header, on the right.

6. Page specs

Home. Left-aligned intro: one plain sentence on what the site is, then two buttons ("Start learning", "Try a tool"). Then "Start here" (3 hand-picked lessons), "Popular tools" (4), "New this month" (3 articles), and an impact line ("Read in 12 countries so far"). No carousel, no video autoplay.

Track page. Title, one-paragraph summary, numbered lesson list with read time and a checkmark once done, and a "Practice" tool at the end.

Article page (lesson template).

1. Title (6-10 words), one-line summary, read time, last reviewed date, author first name + country

2. "In 30 seconds" box: 3 bullet takeaways
3. Body: short sections with H2s, one idea per section, examples from 2+ countries
4. At least one inline interactive element (mini-calculator, tap-to-reveal, or glossary term)
5. "Try it" block linking to the matching tool, with pre-filled values
6. Quiz (3-5 questions)
7. Sources (2+ reputable, linked), "education not advice" line
8. Next lesson / previous lesson

Tool page. Tool title, one sentence on what it answers, inputs on top (or left on desktop), results update live, a plain-language "What this means" sentence under the results, "How it works" (formula, collapsible), and "Learn more" links. Includes a reset button. Share = copy link with inputs in the URL query string (no personal data).

Glossary. A-Z list, search filter, each term with a 1-2 sentence definition + an example. Terms in articles get dotted underlines; tapping one opens a small popover (keyboard accessible).

About. Mission, who built it (first names only for minors unless they consent), how content is reviewed, impact numbers (countries, readers, tool uses), contact email.

Write for Us. Who can write, topics wanted, the style guide link, and how to submit (Google Form or email for v1). Must say: don't include personal info; writers under 18 need a parent's or teacher's OK.

7. Interactive tools (v1 specs)

All math lives in `src/lib/*.ts` as pure functions with unit tests. All money uses the selected currency via `Intl.NumberFormat`. Inputs are `type="number"` with `inputmode="decimal"`, visible labels, units, sensible min/max, and inline validation messages.

Tool	Inputs	Outputs	Notes
Budget Planner	Monthly income; expense rows (name, amount, needs/wants/savings)	Totals by category, % split, comparison with 50/30/20, leftover	Explain that 50/30/20 is a guideline, not a rule. Allow a custom split.
Savings & Compound Growth	Starting amount, monthly contribution, annual rate (%), years, compounding (monthly default)	Final value, total contributed, growth earned, year-by-year table + simple line chart	Rate is user-entered, no default promises. Show "rates are not guaranteed."
Pricing & Break-even	Fixed costs, variable cost per unit, price per unit	Contribution margin, break-even units and revenue, profit at N units	Formula: BE units = fixed / (price – variable). Handle price ≤ variable with a clear message.
Side-Hustle Profit	Units sold/month, price, cost per unit, platform fees %, hours/month	Monthly profit, profit per hour	Helps compare "is this worth my time?"
Loan / EMI	Principal, annual rate, months	EMI, total interest, total paid, amortization table	$EMI = P \cdot r \cdot (1+r)^n / ((1+r)^n - 1)$, r = monthly rate. Handle rate = 0.

Quiz component. Multiple choice (and true/false). One question at a time, instant feedback with a 1-2 sentence explanation, score at the end, retry. Stores "passed" (≥80%) in `localStorage` under `bh:progress`. Retrieval practice (quizzing) is a well-studied way to strengthen long-term learning, so every lesson gets one.

Glossary popover. `<Term id="compound-interest">` renders a button with `aria-expanded`. It opens a popover, closes on Esc or tap outside, and returns focus.

v2: One-Page Business Plan Builder. Guided fields (problem, customer, solution, price, costs, channels, first 3 steps), saved locally, print stylesheet for "Save as PDF."

v2: "Run a Chai Stall" simulator. 4 weekly rounds. Choose price, cups to prepare, and one promotion. See sales, waste, and profit. Teaches demand, cost, and trade-offs. Deterministic seeded randomness so outcomes can be tested.

8. Tech architecture

Where the project is now: plain HTML/CSS/JS with no build step (home, about, and an articles index), hosted from the GitHub repo `passion-project`, with GitHub Pages planned.

Recommended path: migrate to Astro in Phase 0, before there are dozens of articles and tools. Astro still outputs plain static files, so GitHub Pages keeps working (deploy with the official Astro GitHub Action). Gotchas: for a project site at `https://<user>.github.io/passion-project/`, set `site` and `base`: `"/passion-project"` in `astro.config`, and use Astro's link helpers so every link respects the base path. Keep old URLs working (`about.html` → `/about/`) with redirects or `build.format`: `"file"`. Rajvir approves the migration before it starts.

- Astro static site, output: `"static"`. MDX content collections for articles, tracks, glossary, tools (metadata).
- Preact islands for tools, quiz, glossary popovers, and the locale/currency picker. Default `client:visible`.
- CSS: `tokens.css` (DESIGN.md), `base.css`, component-scoped styles. No CSS framework.
- Fonts: self-hosted, subset, `font-display: swap`, at most 2 families (+ Devanagari in v2).
- Images: Astro `<Image>` with AVIF/WebP, explicit width/height, lazy below the fold.
- Search: Pagefind index at build time.
- i18n: Astro i18n routing (`defaultLocale: "en"`, `locales: ["en","hi"]`, `prefixDefaultLocale: false`, fallback `hi→en`). UI strings in `src/i18n/*.json`.
- Hosting: GitHub Pages (current plan) via GitHub Actions; Cloudflare Pages or Netlify are fine alternatives. Custom domain optional.
- CI: GitHub Actions runs build, unit tests, Playwright + axe, Lighthouse CI (mobile).

Suggested repo layout:

```
src/
  components/  Header, Footer, Card, Callout, Term, ToolShell ...
  islands/    BudgetPlanner, CompoundGrowth, BreakEven,
              SideHustle, LoanEmi, Quiz, LocalePicker (.tsx)
  lib/        finance.ts (pure math), format.ts (Intl),
              progress.ts (localStorage)
  content/    articles/, tracks/, glossary/ + config.ts (Zod)
  i18n/       en.json, hi.json
  layouts/    BaseLayout, ArticleLayout, ToolLayout (.astro)
  pages/      index, learn/, tools/, glossary, about, write,
              privacy, disclaimer, 404 (.astro)
  styles/     tokens.css, base.css
tests/
  unit/       finance.test.ts
  e2e/        pages.spec.ts, ally.spec.ts, tools.spec.ts
public/       favicon, social images
```

9. Performance budget (mobile)

- Core Web Vitals at the 75th percentile: **LCP ≤ 2.5s, INP ≤ 200ms, CLS ≤ 0.1**
- Lighthouse mobile: Performance ≥ 90, Accessibility 100, Best Practices ≥ 95, SEO ≥ 95
- Article page: ≤ 50 KB JS (compressed) before interaction; tool page: ≤ 90 KB JS
- Total page weight (first load): ≤ 500 KB on articles; hero images ≤ 120 KB
- Fonts: ≤ 2 families, subset, ≤ 120 KB total
- Test with Chrome DevTools "Slow 4G" + 4x CPU slowdown at 360-400px width

10. Accessibility (WCAG 2.2 AA)

- Contrast: text ≥ 4.5:1 (large text ≥ 3:1). Tokens in DESIGN.md are pre-checked.
- Keyboard: everything reachable and operable; visible focus ring (2px+, not hidden by the sticky header: 2.4.11).
- Target size: ≥ 24×24 CSS px minimum (2.5.8); aim for 44×44 for primary buttons.
- No drag-only interactions (2.5.7). Consistent help link placement (3.2.6).
- Forms: visible labels, error text tied with `aria-describedby`, no re-typing the same info (3.3.7).
- Respect `prefers-reduced-motion`. Don't convey meaning by color alone.
- Charts: provide a data table or text summary.
- Language attribute on `<html>` and on any inline foreign-language text.

11. Internationalization

- Locales: en (v1), hi (v2), more later. Every article has lang and translationOf fields.
- Currency picker (INR, USD, EUR, GBP, BRL, NGN) and number locale are independent of the content language.
- Format with Intl.NumberFormat(locale, { style: "currency", currency }). en-IN groups as 1,00,000. Never hand-format numbers.
- Dates via Intl.DateTimeFormat.
- Region notes in articles use a <RegionNote region="IN"> component so examples adapt.
- CSS logical properties everywhere so Arabic/Urdu (RTL) can be added later.
- Translations are human-reviewed before publishing. Machine drafts are OK as a starting point, never shipped raw.

12. Privacy, safety and legal (not legal advice; get a quick review before launch)

- **Collect nothing personal in v1.** No accounts, no email capture, no contact form (use a plain email address). Progress and preferences stay in localStorage.
- **Why:** India's DPDP Rules (notified Nov 13, 2025) treat anyone under 18 as a child and require verifiable parental consent to process their data; the main obligations take effect May 13, 2027. The EU GDPR (Art. 8) sets a digital consent age between 13 and 16 depending on the country. The US COPPA covers under-13s. Collecting nothing avoids all of this in v1.
- **Analytics:** cookieless and privacy-first (Plausible or Umami); no cookie banner needed when no personal data or cookies are used. Aggregate events only.
- **No third-party embeds** that track (if YouTube is ever used, use youtube-nocookie.com and click-to-load).
- **Finance content limits:** education only, no buy/sell recommendations, no performance promises. India's SEBI (Jan 2025) bars unregistered people from giving investment advice under the label of education and requires market prices used in educational material to be at least 3 months old. Apply that rule to all Indian market examples (and use historical data everywhere as good practice).
- **Disclaimer** on every article and tool: "For learning only. Not financial, legal, or tax advice."
- **Contributors:** first name + country only by default; writers under 18 need a parent's or teacher's OK; no personal stories that identify others.
- **Licensing:** code MIT; articles CC BY-NC-SA 4.0 (lets teachers reuse with credit).

13. Metrics (impact)

- Monthly readers and countries (analytics)
- Articles read, quizzes completed, tools used (events)
- Contributors and languages live
- Publish a short monthly "impact note" on About. These numbers also go on Rajvir's college applications.

14. Roadmap and acceptance criteria

Phase 0, Week 1: Setup

- With Rajvir's OK: migrate the existing pages into Astro (same content), add tokens.css from DESIGN.md, base layout, header/footer, i18n JSON, CI running build + tests, GitHub Pages deploy
- Fix the current hero against DESIGN.md (remove the eyebrow badge and stats row, swap the font stack)
- Done when: npm run build passes in CI; home page renders at 375px and 1280px matching DESIGN.md

Phase 1, Weeks 2-6: MVP

- Content collections + 12 articles + glossary; 5 tools; quiz; search; locale/currency picker; privacy + disclaimer pages; analytics

- Done when: all unit tests pass (including edge cases like rate 0 and price $\leq$ variable cost); axe reports zero serious/critical issues on every page type; Lighthouse mobile meets the budget; every article has a quiz, sources, and a "Try it" tool link; site works with JS disabled for reading articles

Phase 2, Months 2-4

- Hindi, PWA offline reading, business plan builder, chai stall simulator, contributor program, teacher kit
- Done when: /hi/ pages are complete and human-reviewed; articles readable offline after one visit; simulator outcomes pass deterministic tests

15. Open decisions (Rajvir)

- Keep the name LaunchPad? (check it isn't confusing with other "LaunchPad" programs) and pick a domain
- Who reviews content for accuracy (a teacher? a finance professional?)
- Hosting choice and who owns the accounts (use an adult's account if a service requires 18+)
- Which second language after Hindi

DESIGN.md: LaunchPad

Goal: **clean, interactive, human-made, easy to use.** It should feel like a well-edited student magazine plus a set of good tools, not a template or an AI-generated landing page.

1. Personality

- Confident, calm, practical. Like a sharp older student explaining something over lunch.
- Editorial, not "startup SaaS." Real structure, real content, very little decoration.
- Keeps LaunchPad's existing deep green as the brand accent (already in css/style.css).

2. Color tokens (contrast checked on - -paper)

```
:root {
  --paper: #FBFAF7; /* page background (warm off-white) */
  --paper-2: #F4F1EA; /* section / card background */
  --ink: #16181D; /* headings + primary text (17.0:1) */
  --ink-2: #3A3F4B; /* body text (10.1:1) */
  --muted: #5B6270; /* captions, meta (5.9:1): smallest text allowed */
  --line: #E3DED3; /* borders, dividers (decorative only) */
  --accent: #1C5D3A; /* LaunchPad green: buttons (white text 7.9:1), links (7.5:1) */
  --accent-deep: #154A2E; /* hover / pressed (9.8:1) */
  --accent-soft: #E6F2EA; /* tinted panels; accent text on it is 6.8:1 */
  --highlight: #F2C14E; /* highlight fills only, always with --ink text (10.6:1) */
  --error: #B42318; /* (6.3:1) */
  --focus: #1C5D3A; /* 2px outline + 2px offset */
}
@media (prefers-color-scheme: dark) {
  :root {
    --paper: #12161B; --paper-2: #1A2027;
    --ink: #EDEBE6; --ink-2: #D5D2CB; --muted: #B9BEC8;
    --line: #2B333D; --accent: #8FD1A8; --accent-deep: #B5E3C6;
    --accent-soft: #1D3327;
  }
}
```

Rules: one dominant color (dark ink on warm paper), one accent (green), one highlight (warm yellow) used sparingly (highlighted numbers, the "In 30 seconds" box). In dark mode, buttons use - -accent with - -paper text (10.3:1). Never put text in light grays like #9AA0AE (fails contrast).

3. Typography

- Headings: **Literata** (serif, readable, warm), weights 600/700.
- Body and UI: **Atkinson Hyperlegible Next** (made for legibility, distinct from the usual defaults), weights 400/700.
- Hindi (v2): **Noto Serif Devanagari** (headings) + **Noto Sans Devanagari** (body).

- Numbers in tools: body font with `font-variant-numeric: tabular-nums`.
- Scale (mobile → desktop): body 17px → 18px; line-height 1.6; H1 32 → 44px; H2 24 → 30px; measure 60-72ch.
- Sentence case for headings and buttons. No ALL CAPS labels.
- **Banned fonts** (overused in AI-generated sites): Inter, Roboto, Arial, Space Grotesk, Geist, Instrument Serif, Poppins, Montserrat. Don't use a serif italic on a single word inside a sans headline.

4. Layout

- Left-aligned, editorial. Content column max 720px; tools use a 2-column layout at ≥ 900 px (inputs left, results right).
- Spacing scale (px): 4, 8, 12, 16, 24, 32, 48, 64, 96.
- Radius: 6px on inputs, buttons, and cards (the current CSS uses 10px; bring it down). No pill-shaped everything.
- Shadows: none by default. A single 1px border (`--line`) defines cards. No glows, no layered colored shadows.
- **One card style** across the site. Don't invent variants per section.
- Sticky header is small (≤ 56 px) and must never hide the focused element.

5. Components

- **Button:** primary (green bg, white text), secondary (ink border, transparent), text link. Min height 44px. Verb-first labels ("Try the calculator").
- **Card:** paper-2 bg, 1px line border, 6px radius, title + one line + meta. Whole card clickable with a real link inside.
- **Callout "In 30 seconds":** no colored left border; use a full soft marigold tint background (`color-mix(in srgb, var(--marigold) 22%, var(--paper))`) with ink text and a small heading.
- **Term (glossary):** dotted underline, button semantics, popover.
- **ToolShell:** title, "answers:" line, inputs, live results, "What this means," collapsible "How it works," reset + copy-link.
- **Quiz:** one question per view, big tappable options (full-width), feedback text in success/error colors plus an icon and words (not color alone).
- **Progress mark:** a small check next to finished lessons. No streaks, badges, confetti, or leaderboards in v1.

6. Imagery and icons

- Prefer simple, custom diagrams (SVG) that explain an idea: a supply/demand curve, a cash flow arrow, a chai-stall cost breakdown.
- Photos only if real (club events with consent) or clearly credited. No generic stock "diverse team high-fiving," no 3D blobs, no abstract gradient orbs.
- Icons: one outline set (for example Phosphor or Lucide), 1.5px stroke, only where they add meaning (tool type, warning). Never emoji as icons. Never an icon in a colored circle above every card.

7. Motion

- Only functional: results updating (150-200ms fade/number tween), popovers opening, accordions.
- No parallax, no scroll-jacking, no floating decorative animations.
- Respect `prefers-reduced-motion`: `reduce` (turn tweens off).

8. Writing in the interface (microcopy)

- Plain and direct. "Start learning," not "Unlock your potential."
- Avoid hype words: revolutionize, unlock, supercharge, seamless, empower, elevate, journey, game-changer, "in today's fast-paced world."
- Don't talk down ("Hey kids!") and don't try too hard to be cool. Teens reject "kiddie" design; young adults dislike being patronized.

- Numbers and examples > adjectives.

9. The "does this look AI-made?" checklist (fail any → fix it)

- ☐ Centered hero with a badge/pill above a giant headline
- ☐ Purple/lavender or rainbow gradients, glowing blurred shadows
- ☐ Three identical feature cards with an icon on top
- ☐ "1, 2, 3" step rows or a stat banner ("10K+ users") with made-up numbers
- ☐ Emoji used as icons in nav or lists
- ☐ Permanent dark mode with low-contrast gray body text
- ☐ Colored left-border accent on every card
- ☐ Glassmorphism panels
- ☐ ALL CAPS section labels everywhere
- ☐ Generic copy ("Empowering the next generation of leaders")
- ☐ Mixed card styles and inconsistent spacing
- ☐ Banned fonts from section 3

10. Usability rules for 15-21 year-olds

- Content in short chunks with clear H2s; one idea per section; bold the key sentence.
- Aim for reading level around grade 8 (Hemingway/Flesch-Kincaid). Define every term the first time.
- Speed is part of the design: slow pages lose teens.
- Interactivity must do something (calculate, test, decide), not decorate.
- No forced sign-up. Sharing = copy link.
- Labels over icons in navigation. Max 5 top-level items.
- Big touch targets, forgiving inputs (accept "1,00,000" and "100000").

11. Screens to verify on every UI change

- 360×800 (budget Android), 390×844 (iPhone), 768×1024 (tablet), 1280×800 (laptop)
- Light and dark mode, 200% zoom, keyboard-only pass, reduced motion on

12. Fix list for the current pages

- Remove the eyebrow line above the H1 ("Free · Global · For ages 15-21"); fold that info into the intro sentence.
- Remove the hero stats row (Free / Global / Plain); say it in one plain sentence instead.
- Replace the system font stack (it falls back to Roboto/Arial) with the fonts in section 3.
- Left-align the hero; keep one card style for topics and articles.

CONTENT_GUIDE.md: articles, voice, and limits

Article frontmatter (Zod schema in src/content/config.ts)

```
---
title: "How a chai stall makes money"           # 6-10 words, sentence case
summary: "Unit economics explained with one cup of tea." # ≤ 120 chars
track: how-business-works                       # money-basics | start-something | how-business-works
order: 1
lang: en                                         # en | hi | ...
translationOf: null                            # slug of the source article if translated
readingMinutes: 5
level: beginner                                # beginner | intermediate
regions: [IN, US, GLOBAL]                      # examples used
author: { name: "Rajvir", country: "US" }       # first name + country only
reviewedBy: "LaunchPad editor"                 # role, not a minor's full name
lastReviewed: 2026-09-17
glossary: [unit-economics, gross-margin, fixed-cost]
tool: break-even                               # tool linked in "Try it"
sources:
  - { title: "...", url: "https://...", publisher: "..." }
quiz:
  - q: "If a cup costs ₹8 to make and sells for ₹15, what is the margin per cup?"
    options: ["₹7", "₹15", "₹23", "₹8"]
    answer: 0
    why: "Margin per unit = price - variable cost = 15 - 8."
---
```

Voice

- Second person ("you"), short sentences, active voice, grade ~8 reading level.
- Start with a real situation a 15-21 year-old faces. Then the idea. Then an example from 2+ countries. Then "try it."
- Use numbers. Show the math once, simply.
- No hype, no fear, no "get rich" framing. No slang that will date fast.
- Always define jargon with a Term.

Structure (every article)

1. "In 30 seconds" (3 bullets)
2. 3-5 short sections (H2)
3. One inline interaction
4. "Try it" tool link with pre-filled values
5. Quiz (3-5 questions)
6. Sources (2+), and the disclaimer line

Finance content limits (must follow)

- Education only. Never say what to buy, sell, or hold. No named "best" funds, stocks, or coins.
- No performance promises ("you'll make 12%"). Illustrative rates must be labeled as examples.
- Indian market examples: prices/data at least 3 months old (SEBI, Jan 2025). Use historical data everywhere.
- Point to official sources for tax and legal questions (for example, the tax authority of that country).
- Scam articles: describe patterns, never link to scam sites.

Starter article list (24)

Money Basics: Your first paycheck or pocket money: where it should go · Needs vs wants and the 50/30/20 idea · Compound growth explained with small monthly amounts · Saving vs investing: what's the difference? · UPI, cards, and "buy now, pay later" · Credit scores: US scores vs CIBIL in India · Scams that target students · Inflation: why the same money buys less

Start Something: Test a business idea in a weekend without spending money · Pricing your first product · Break-even: how many do you need to sell? · Selling online: Instagram, WhatsApp Business, Etsy, marketplaces · The one-page business plan · Pitch your idea in 60 seconds · Side hustles for students (and checking your local rules) · Taxes basics for young earners (general + official links)

How Business Works: How a chai stall makes money · What an income statement tells you · Supply and demand around you · How startups raise money · How businesses use AI (and where it goes wrong) · How to read a stock pitch (education only) · Careers in business: what people actually do · How a phone gets from factory to your pocket

Review checklist (before publishing)

- ☐ Facts checked against the listed sources
- ☐ Examples from 2+ countries; currency via the picker where numbers appear
- ☐ Reading level ~grade 8; jargon defined
- ☐ Quiz answers correct and explained
- ☐ No advice, no promises, disclaimer present
- ☐ Alt text on images; charts have a text summary
- ☐ Author and reviewer fields filled

CLAUDE.md (goes in the project root)

This is the short file Claude Code reads at the start of every session. It's kept brief on purpose: Anthropic's guidance warns that long CLAUDE.md files get partly ignored.

LaunchPad

Free, global learning hub that teaches business ideas, entrepreneurship, and money skills to people aged 15-21, especially those without a financial adviser or family guidance (for example, students in India with internet but no advisor).

Articles + interactive tools + quizzes, built for phones and slow connections. Owner: Rajvir Dixit (college passion project; grew out of his school club, Business Lab).

Read these before feature work:

- @docs/PROJECT_BRIEF.md: scope, pages, tools, roadmap, acceptance criteria
- @docs/DESIGN.md: visual system and the "don't look AI-made" rules
- @docs/CONTENT_GUIDE.md: article schema, voice, and legal limits on finance content
- docs/KICKOFF_PROMPTS.md is for Rajvir; docs/LaunchPad_Build_Brief.pdf is the same plan as a PDF

Current state (Sept 2026)

- Plain HTML/CSS/JS, no build step: index.html, about.html, articles/index.html, css/style.css, js/main.js, assets/.
- Run locally: `python3 -m http.server 8000` (also in .claude/launch.json), then open `http://localhost:8000`.
- GitHub remote: `dixitrajvir20-blip/passion-project`. Planned hosting: GitHub Pages.
- Known gaps vs DESIGN.md: the hero has an eyebrow badge above the H1 and a stats row (both on the "looks AI-made" checklist); the font stack uses system fonts incl. Roboto/Arial; no tools, quizzes, glossary, or article pages yet.

Stack

- Recommended next step (PROJECT_BRIEF section 8): move to Astro (static output, still deploys to GitHub Pages) before content and tools grow. IMPORTANT: ask Rajvir before migrating. Never migrate or delete existing pages silently.
- Either way: no Tailwind, no UI kits. Plain CSS with custom properties (tokens in DESIGN.md). Interactive tools as small islands (Preact if Astro, vanilla JS modules if not).

- Calculator math lives in pure functions with unit tests (Vitest). Pages get Playwright + axe checks once the build exists.
- Analytics: cookieless only (Plausible or Umami). Never Google Analytics, Meta pixel, or other trackers.

Hard rules

- IMPORTANT: No accounts, logins, forms that collect personal data, or third-party trackers in v1. Progress lives in localStorage only.
- No stock tips, buy/sell calls, or "best fund to buy." Education only. Indian market prices in examples must be at least 3 months old.
- Every page must meet WCAG 2.2 AA, work by keyboard, and meet the mobile performance budget in PROJECT_BRIEF.md.
- Money is formatted with `Intl.NumberFormat` using the chosen locale and currency (en-IN shows 1,00,000).
- Follow DESIGN.md. No purple gradients, glowing shadows, emoji icons, or fonts from its banned list.
- Keep user-facing text in one place per locale (JSON) once i18n starts; don't scatter strings.

Workflow

- For anything touching more than 2 files: plan first, then build.
- Prove it works: run tests/build, and for UI changes screenshot at 360px and 1280px and compare against DESIGN.md.
- Small commits with clear messages on a feature branch. Don't push or merge without Rajvir's OK.

Kickoff prompts for Claude Code (copy these in order)

0. Setup (you): CLAUDE.md and docs/ are already in your passion project folder. Open Terminal, run `cd ~/Desktop/"passion project"`, then `claude`. Start a new branch first: `git switch -c plan-docs` (then commit the docs when you're happy).

1. Interview + plan (plan mode on: Shift+Tab until "plan mode")

Read CLAUDE.md and everything in docs/. Then interview me with the AskUserQuestion tool about anything unclear or risky (name, domain, hosting, content review, edge cases). Don't ask what the docs already answer. Then look at the existing site files and write PLAN.md for Phase 0 and Phase 1 only: whether to migrate the current HTML pages to Astro (explain the trade-offs for me first), the files to create or change, and how each step will be verified.

2. Phase 0 build

Implement Phase 0 from PLAN.md on a new branch. Move the existing pages over without losing content, add tokens.css from DESIGN.md, the base layout, header/footer, i18n JSON, CI (build + vitest + playwright + axe + lighthouse), and the GitHub Pages deploy (set site and base for /passion-project). Fix the hero using DESIGN.md section 12. Run the build and tests. Take screenshots at 360px and 1280px, compare them with DESIGN.md's checklist, list any differences, and fix them.

3. Math first

Write `src/lib/finance.ts` with pure functions for budget split, compound growth, break-even, side-hustle profit, and EMI, and `src/lib/format.ts` using `Intl.NumberFormat`. Write unit tests first, including edge cases (rate 0, price $\leq$ variable cost, empty inputs, en-IN grouping 1,00,000). Make them pass.

4. One tool end to end

Build the Break-even tool page using ToolShell and a Preact island (client:visible). Inputs, live results, "What this means," "How it works," reset, copy-link with query params. Add Playwright tests and an axe check. Show me the screenshots and the test output.

5. Content pipeline

Create the content collections and Zod schema from CONTENT_GUIDE.md, the ArticleLayout, Term popover, Quiz island, and RegionNote. Add one sample article with a quiz. Verify the build fails if required frontmatter is missing.

6. Review pass (fresh context)

Use a subagent to review the whole site against DESIGN.md section 9 (AI-look checklist), section 10 (usability), and PROJECT_BRIEF.md sections 9-12 (performance, accessibility, i18n, privacy). Report only real gaps with file references.

Tips: /clear between unrelated tasks; if you correct Claude twice on the same thing, /clear and restate the request more precisely; always ask for evidence (test output, screenshots).

Sources

- [Claude Code docs: Best practices](#)
- [Anthropic: Improving frontend design through Skills](#)
- [Claude Cookbook: Prompting for frontend aesthetics](#)
- [Developers Digest: AI design slop, 16 patterns](#)
- [Nielsen Norman Group: Teenager's UX](#)
- [Nielsen Norman Group: Young adults as web users](#)
- [TetraLogical: What's new in WCAG 2.2](#)
- [W3C: WCAG 2.2](#)
- [web.dev: How Core Web Vitals thresholds were defined](#)
- [Astro docs: Islands architecture](#)
- [Astro docs: Internationalization](#)
- [Pagefind: static low-bandwidth search](#)
- [Plausible: cookieless web analytics](#)
- [Aflatoun: PISA 2022 financial literacy results](#)
- [OECD: PISA 2022 Results Volume IV](#)
- [Business Standard: India internet users cross 950M \(IAMAI 2025\)](#)
- [Privacy World: India's DPDP Rules](#)
- [GDPR Local: Digital age of consent by country](#)
- [Social Samosa: SEBI rules on stock market education](#)
- [RetrievalPractice.org: effect sizes and meta-analyses](#)
- [Zerodha Varsity \(free Indian investing education, for comparison\)](#)

Legal notes in this brief are research summaries, not legal advice. Have a knowledgeable adult review privacy and finance-content rules before launch.